

Karthik V Meenaakshisundaram

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Professional Summary

Product and design leader in the making with 8+ years of experience building hardware and software products across neurotechnology, SaaS, and immersive technology. Experience spans both academia and industry — from HCI research to shipping products across domains including SaaS, Extended Reality, and Healthcare. Specializes in bridging engineering, design, and business strategy into coherent products that are both technically grounded and market-ready.

Professional Experience

Neurostellar

Design and Product Lead

Chennai, India

Aug 2024 — Present

- Joined as Design Lead to help take Orbit from prototype to market; established the UX, brand, and go- to- market design foundations before expanding scope to lead the Product function — now accountable for both product and design outcomes across Orbit.
- Drive technical product management for Orbit — translating EEG and PPG signal-processing capabilities into a structured product roadmap, owning feature prioritization, and partnering with engineering to ship a consumer neurowearable from zero.
- Work closely with GTM to shape positioning, pricing strategy, and growth initiatives — connecting product capabilities to market opportunity in a nascent consumer neurotechnology category.
- Lead Industrial Design, Interaction Design, and Communication Design — raising the craft bar across hardware form, digital experience, and brand, resulting in a coherent product identity across every customer touchpoint.
- Established design and product operations from scratch — design systems, release pipelines, and cross- functional workflows — enabling a lean team to move at the speed a 0- to- 1 hardware- software product demands.

NeXR Labs

Founder & CEO

Uppsala, Sweden

Jun 2023 — Nov 2024

- Founded an extended reality (XR) startup; led all aspects of product strategy, design, business development, investor communication, and early team formation.
- Gained hands- on experience in 0- to- 1 product building, go- to- market planning, and lean startup operations.
- Dissolved the startup due to personal reasons and relocated back to India.

Warpin

UX/UI Designer

Stockholm, Sweden

Mar 2022 — Aug 2023

- Designed and evaluated immersive XR solutions across multiple client projects; improved usability and accessibility of AR and VR applications.
- Built a generic quality assurance framework for XR app development, standardizing usability, accessibility, and user testing across the engineering organization.
- Created UI asset systems and visual style guides adopted as best practice standards across all projects.

RISE Research Institutes of Sweden

Stockholm, Sweden

HCI Researcher, Ethics of Extended Realities

Jan 2023 — Jun 2023

- Conducted a comprehensive Systematic Literature Review on ethical issues in AR, VR, and Mixed Reality across healthcare, education, entertainment, and enterprise domains.
- Identified cross-domain ethical risks and authored practical design recommendations published as part of a master's thesis at Uppsala University.

Uppsala University, Dept. of Informatics and Media

Uppsala, Sweden

UX Researcher, Interactive ML for Physical Training

Aug 2022 — Dec 2022

- Interned on a Swedish Research Council-funded project led by Prof. Annika Waern; researched, prototyped, and fabricated wearable sensor devices to feed an interactive ML model for personalized physical training.
- Conducted user testing sessions to validate sensor wearable designs and iterate on product fit, comfort, and data quality.

Zoho Corporation

Chennai, India

Product Designer

Jul 2017 — Jul 2021

- Led product and UX design for Site24x7 (all-in-one DevOps and IT monitoring), StatusIQ (hosted status pages and incident communication), and Site24x7 Tools — collectively serving over 10,000 customers daily.
- Owned the full design lifecycle: product strategy, responsive and accessible UI design, UX copywriting, icon systems, and marketing illustration across web and mobile platforms.
- Collaborated closely with product managers throughout the entire development lifecycle; built scalable design systems and component libraries used across multiple product lines.
- Designed front-end experiences and contributed to HTML/CSS implementation for high-traffic product pages.

Consultancy & Speaking

Speaking & Mentorship

Speaker, Mentor & Design Educator

2018 — Present

- Keynote speaker at Neurogati and IIITDM on “Building a BCI Product from 0 to 1” — presented Orbit as a live case study and a generalizable BCI product development framework to audiences of engineers, founders, and students.
- Speaker on design leadership topics including how to choose the right design school, building strong design teams, and fostering design culture within product organizations.
- Mentor designers and developers on career growth, higher education abroad, and transitioning into design from adjacent fields (engineering, architecture, technology); 8+ mentees have successfully transitioned into design roles.

Professional Consultancy

Product, Design & Operations Advisor — Early-Stage Startups

2024 — Present

- Engaged by Neurostellar as Senior UX Consultant (Aug–Nov 2024) to define and build UX strategy, brand, and design operations for the Orbit product launch from scratch ahead of a full-time hire.
- Advise multiple stealth-stage startups (founded by operators and domain experts) on establishing early design, product, and operations functions — covering hiring frameworks, design systems, and product strategy from 0 to 1.

Education

MSc, Human-Computer Interaction

2023

Uppsala University, Sweden

Expert-Level Skills

Product: 0- to- 1 product development, business model development, cross- platform product development, go- to- market and campaign planning, product-market fit, product operations, product strategy, roadmapping

Design: Accessible design, brand and communication design, design engineering, design operations, design systems, inclusive UX, UI design, usability testing, UX research, AIxDesign, Claude Design, Figma

Research: HCI research, mixed methods, prototyping, qualitative and quantitative analysis, systematic literature review, user testing

Technology: AI-assisted product development, app development, generative AI tooling, LLM integration, prompt engineering, SEO analytics

Leadership: Cross-functional collaboration, executive communication, public speaking, resource management and optimisation, startup finance (basic), startup founding, team leadership

Languages: English (Fluent), Tamil (Native), Telugu (Native), Swedish (Elementary)